Digital Dealer CONFERENCE & EXPO SEPTEMBER 22-23, 2026 | Huntington Place | Detroit, MI
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The Digital Dealer AI Hackathon is back!

Build the Future of Auto Retail



What's the Digital Dealer AI Hackathon?

The 2026 Digital Dealer AI Hackathon is a competitive, high-energy session where teams work together to develop AI-powered marketing solutions built specifically for the automotive industry. You don't need to be a developer or a data scientist.

You need to be curious, motivated and ready to work. Hosted by Brent Wees, one of the most recognized voices in automotive digital marketing, the hackathon brings together dealership professionals, marketers and operators to tackle real problems with real tools, in real time.

Secure my Spot!

On September 23, team up with automotive retail professionals to build and present an AI-powered marketing solution in just three hours. This hands-on competition turns ideas into real prototypes, with top teams presenting their solutions on stage.

Participation is limited to Digital Dealer Full Conference Pass holders. Spots are available on a first-come, first-served basis.

What You'll Do

- Work in small teams to design and build an AI-driven marketing solution for an automotive dealership challenge
- Collaborate with expert table captains who guide your team through ideation, tool selection and execution
- Use hands-on access to AI tools to turn strategy into a working prototype
- Present your solution on the DealerTech Live Stage in front of your peers

Why It's Worth Your Time

- Walk away with practical AI skills you can apply at your dealership immediately
- Build meaningful connections with peers who face the same marketing and operational challenges you do
- Get direct exposure to the capabilities of today's AI tools in a supported, low-stakes environment
- Compete for recognition and make your mark at one of automotive retail's most forward-looking events

Schedule and Logistics

The AI Hackathon takes place on **September 23**, Day Two of Digital at Huntington Place in Detroit, MI.

Session	Time
AI Hackathon	1:00 PM – 4:00 PM
Team Presentations & Reception	4:15 PM – 5:00 PM

Presentations and the closing reception take place on the DealerTech Live Stage in the expo hall. After three hours of building, your team takes the stage to present what you've created to the broader Digital Dealer audience.

Who Can Participate?

Participation in the AI Hackathon is **exclusive to Digital Dealer Full Conference Pass holders.**

If you're attending Digital Dealer with a full conference pass, you're eligible to register. If you haven't secured your pass yet or have an expo-only pass, click here to register for the full conference pass.



Frequently Asked Questions?

- Do I need coding or AI experience to participate?
- What kind of solutions will teams build?
- What happens after the Hackathon?
- Is the Hackathon included with my Full Conference Pass?

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